

Quotes of note in Support of Veteran Status for the United States cadet Nurse Corps

"I am deeply concerned lest this war might be lost on the home front because of the lack of wisdom in using trained people where they can do the most good."

Dr William P, Shepherd: US PH Physician on the west coast in response to the armed forces appeal for more nurses to enlist in the Army Nurse Corps. 1943: before the USCNC.

Cadets like Esther were an essential part of our military force. They were members of the Public Health service, one of our Nation's seven uniformed services. They served under the auspices of commissioned officers, wearing patches certified by the Secretary of the Army. And they treated they treated the injuries of troops returning home from the war front. Despite their dedicated service to our Nation, it is unfortunate that the Department of Defense has elected to block efforts to recognize these women as military veterans."

Excerpted from Senate Concurrent Resolution 72 (2003) Senator Tom Daschle

"The time and effort of these women has simply been ignored, and we need to think about the gross inequity that has occurred. We should not forget that in a nation depleted of registered nurses during time of war, these women filled the gap and picked up the slack-they cared for the sick and for many of our soldiers who returned home to heal. When our country was weakened by an ugly war, this now small group of women was there to make it strong. When called by their country to serve in a time of need, these women came forward to help their nation through a difficult time. Now they call upon their country to correct an oversight, an injustice. For whatever reason, these women were overlooked. We have an opportunity today to correct that oversight."...

Representative Jim Slattery [D KS-2]

"...We should take time out to pay tribute to the dedicated group of women who promised to stay in nursing in service of their country for as long as it was necessary to win the war that raged when they entered service. Their contribution was critical to the many young men for whom they cared. It was a contribution we should never forget. By stepping into uniform for their country, the {U.S. Cadet} Nurse Corps played an essential role in ending the war. They should be honored for their efforts."

Army Surgeon General Norman T. Kirk in his tribute to the "Corps" on its'50th anniversary